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Research Interests

Labor Economics, Applied Micro, Spatial Economics

Education

PhD in Economics, **University of Toronto** 2020 - 2026 (Expected)

Committee: Kory Kroft (supervisor), Ismael Mourifié, Nathaniel Baum-Snow, Clémentine Van Effenterre

B.Sc. in Economics & Mathematics, **University of Toronto** 2016 - 2020

Research

Monopsony in Space: Commuting & Labor Market Power (Job Market Paper)

Decoding Gender Bias in Interviews (Under Review)
with Ashley C. Craig and Clémentine Van Effenterre

Protectionist Tariffs with Third Country Effects (In Progress)
with Mahmood Haddara and Daniel Trefler

The Role of Production Hierarchies in Coordinating Specialization (In Progress)
with Kevin Lim and Aloysius Siow

Research Awards and Grants

University of Toronto Doctoral Fellowship	2020 - 2025
University of Toronto Excellence Award	2020
Nanda Choudhry Prize in Economics	2017-18

Conference and Seminar Presentations

Society of Labor Economics (*participant*)	2025
NBER Gender in the Economy (*participant*)	2025
Columbia Management, Analytics, and Data Conference (MAD)	2024
IZA Workshop: Matching Workers and Jobs Online	2023
Advances with Field Experiments (AFE)	2023
Chicago Price Theory Summer Camp	2023

NBER Summer Institute Entrepreneurship (*participant)* 2023

Professional Experience

Teaching Assistant, University of Toronto 2020–2026

Research Assistant, University of Toronto 2021–2024

- *Prof. Kory Kroft:* Empirical analysis of subcontracting's effect on firm organization; Theoretical derivations for labor market models with market power.
- *Prof. Peter Morrow:* Quantitative labor market model simulations in MATLAB; Model design & theoretical derivations.
- *Prof. Clémentine Van Effenterre & Prof. Ashley Craig:* Empirical analysis; experimental design, and setup on Qualtrics

Referee Service

American Economic Journal: Economic Policy

Languages

Language: Arabic (native), English (fluent)

Programming: Stata, R, MATLAB, Julia, Python, LaTeX

References

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Abstracts

Monopsony in Space: Commuting & Labor Market Power

(Job Market Paper)

This paper studies the role of commuting costs in shaping labor market power, and the allocation of workers to firms. I build, identify, and estimate a two-sided labor market matching model featuring strategic interactions in wage-setting, commuting costs, and residential choice. Changes to workers' commuting costs affects their allocation to firms, and due to strategic interactions, labor supply elasticity. I study the direct and distributional consequences of a commuting shock through the lens of a subway expansion in Vancouver during the 2010 Winter Olympics. Empirically, workers who gained improved access to the subway network experienced an increase in earnings by 1.5-2% relative to workers with no change in access. I provide suggestive evidence the effect is driven by job switchers who travel farther to new employers. Using the estimated model, I show that the expansion reallocated workers in affected areas to more productive firms. In equilibrium, neighborhoods with improved access experienced an 8% drop in labor market concentration. Simultaneously, workers in other neighborhoods were crowded out from high productivity jobs, and faced worse labor market outcomes. This showcases how improved commuting costs for some neighborhoods has adverse spillover effects on other areas through increased competition amongst workers for high-paying jobs. I further show that 10-15% of the spatial variation in wage markdowns, can be explained by the non-uniform access to firms within a Commuting Zone. This operates through changes in worker to firm sorting, underscoring the role of differential job access in shaping labor market power across space.

Decoding Gender Bias in Interviews

with Ashley C. Craig and Clémentine Van Effenterre

Performance evaluation in interviews is an important part of hiring decisions. We combine experiments, administrative data and video analysis to understand what drives gender bias during in-person evaluations in the technology industry. Leveraging 60,000 mock interviews on a platform for software engineers, we find that average ratings for code quality are 12 percent of a standard deviation lower for women. We use two field experiments to study what drives these gaps. Our first experiment shows that providing evaluators with automated performance measures does not reduce gender gaps. Our second experiment compares blind to non-blind evaluations without video interaction: There is no gender gap in either case. These results rule out traditional models of discrimination. Instead, we show that gender gaps widen with extended personal interaction, and are larger for evaluators from regions where implicit association test scores are higher. Video analysis of the interviews further shows that female candidates are more likely to apologize; and interviewers show more dismissive behavior toward women, which is linked to lower ratings. Our findings on the critical role of personal interactions provide a potential reason why correspondence studies often fail to detect gender bias.

Worker Protectionism with Third Country Responses

with Mahmood Haddara and Daniel Trefler

It is well known that import competition can have strong negative effects on domestic workers. Shielding workers from these shocks is among the primary stated objectives of tariffs. In practice, however, tariffs often fail to increase domestic production. For example, the 2018 US tariffs on China benefited countries such as Thailand and Vietnam far more than domestic producers. These "third country effects" cannot be explained by workhorse trade models. We build on recent methodological advancements to assess the effect of bilateral tariff changes on sectoral employment while incorporating third country effects. Our framework combines flexible substitution patterns with an otherwise standard model of labor market frictions. The effects of tariffs in this environment are heterogeneous across workers and products, providing a rich laboratory for counterfactual analyses. We use our model to quantify the efficacy of tariffs in protecting domestic workers and reversing job losses from free trade.

The Role of Production Hierarchies in Coordinating Specialization

with Kevin Lim and Aloysius Siow

This paper investigates how firms allocate employees with different skills in its hierarchy, and the consequences on within firm innequality. Since Ricardo, economists have recognized the gains from specialization and the division of labor. In order to take advantage of such specialization, the firm has to produce many task outputs and aggregate them into different final products. Each firm has to decide which tasks to do, who to hire to do them and to coordinate the production and aggregation of these different task outputs. Builiding on Chandler (1993), this paper provides an analytic framework which shows who does what in the organization which, in the end, produces different task outputs to be aggregated into different final products. The two level hierarchy, consisting of a supervisor and their subordinates, is the building block of this organizational perspective. Complex hierarchies are obtained by concatenating multiple two level hierarchies. Transfer pricing provides a mechanism to coordinate each two level hierarchy to produce its efficient level of task output. The CEO chooses tasks and executive managers to do those tasks. Given the CEO choices, each executive manager chooses other tasks and subordinates to do those, and so on. The choice of tasks by the CEO affects the productivity of executive managers and propagate further down the chain of command. In this way, strategic and communicational skills of higher level managers have large productivity effects on the firm than the skills of lower level managers, explaining why the growth of managerial earnings increase with the level of the hierarchy.

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